

MAT 6973 002

SP: Differential Geometry

Course Syllabus - Spring 2026



Course Information

Course Description: Prerequisite: Consent of instructor. An organized course offering the opportunity for specialized study not normally or not often available as part of the regular course offerings. Special Problems courses may be repeated for credit when topics vary, but not more than 6 hours, regardless of discipline, will apply to the Master's degree. This course has Differential Tuition. Course Fee: GS01 \$90.

Credit Hours: 3

Course Modality: Traditional in-person

Meeting Times

Duration: 01/20/2026-05/13/2026

Campus: Main Campus

Location: [MH 3.02.12](#)

Time(s): MW 7:30 PM - 8:45 PM

Learning Goals

At the end of the course, you will be able to:

Understand how to compute and interpret curvature of curves and manifolds.

Have tools to solve geometric problems in physics and applied mathematics.

Skills Goals

At the end of the course, you will be able to:

Use tensor calculus to solve problems.

Use and understand abstract geometric language (e.g. vector and tensor bundles, measures of curvature)

Communicate with Me

Instructor Name: Duy Nguyen Vu Hoang

Department

Mathematics

Office Location

FLN 4.01.44

Student Hours

Monday 6:00-7:30

Email Address: duynguyenvu.hoang@utsa.edu

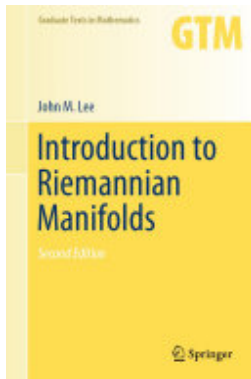
Preferred Method of Communication

Email

About Me & My Teaching Philosophy

Successful teaching has no recipe one can follow blindly. I believe that it is important to be flexible, adjust to the students' needs, guide them and walk the extra mile to help them succeed. Any approach I take I keep in mind that **I'm not teaching math, I am teaching students.**

Course Materials



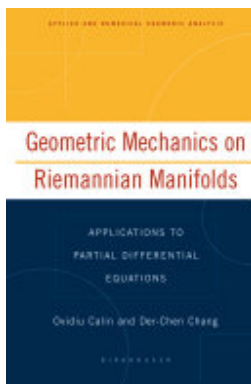
Introduction to Riemannian Manifolds

ISBN: 9783319917559

Authors: John M. Lee

Publisher: Springer

Publication Date: 2019-01-02



Geometric Mechanics on Riemannian Manifolds

ISBN: 9780817643546

Authors: Ovidiu Calin, Der-Chen Chang

Publisher: Springer Science & Business Media

Publication Date: 2005-01-01

To enhance your learning and adequately prepare for all assignments and assessments, please consider all course materials listed above, along with additional content provided in class, posted to our course site, or included in the Course Schedule, as required reading and study unless indicated as optional.

Assessments and Assignments

Regular assignments will be provided to the student every two weeks.
The student will have two weeks respectively for completion of these problems before the deadline.
The assignments will range from problems needing either a mathematical or computational solution according to the topic of interest (including the latter when/if appropriate).

Activities and Grading

Activity	Quantity	%
Homework	4-5	30
Midterm project	1	30
Final term paper	1	40
Total		100%

Distribution of Course Assignments, Their Quantity, and Contribution to Final Grade.

Grade Distribution and Letter Grade

Letter Grade	Grade Range
A+	97.5-100
A	95-97.5
A-	90-95
B+	87.5-90
B	85-87.5
B-	80-85
C+	77.5-80
C	75-77.5
C-	70-75
D+	65-70
D	65-67.5
D-	60-65
F	<60

Grade Distribution and Letter Grade

Course Guidelines for the Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence

You may not use generative AI to solve homework problems, although a general internet search is allowed and encouraged. You may use generative AI to generate text for the final project, but you must state in a preamble that:

1. I have used generative AI while writing this term paper
2. I have verified all mathematical arguments and checked their correctness.

Course Expectations & Policies

Video and Audio Recording

As the instructor of this course, I may record meetings and lessons. You are expected to follow appropriate University policies and maintain the security of passwords used to access recorded lectures. Recordings may not be published, reproduced, or shared with those not in the class. If the instructor or a UTSA office plans any other uses for the recordings, consent of the students identifiable in the recordings is required before such use unless an exception is allowed by law. For more information on your privacy and class recordings, review [Student Privacy \(FERPA\) in Virtual Classrooms and Other Educational Recordings](#) and the [Guide to Secure Video Conferencing Tools](#).

Academic Freedom

Academic freedom¹ is a cornerstone of the University. Academic freedom in its teaching aspect is fundamental for the protection of the rights of the teacher in teaching and of the student to freedom in learning.² Each faculty member is entitled to full freedom in the classroom discussing the subject that the faculty member teaches.³ The University of Texas at San Antonio will not penalize or discipline members of the faculty because of their exercise of academic freedom.

Along with this freedom comes responsibility. It is the responsibility of faculty members to ensure that topics taught are related to the classroom subject. Students should be free to take reasoned exception to the data or views offered in any course of study and to reserve judgment about matters of opinion, but they are responsible for learning the content of any course of study for which they are enrolled.⁴ It is not the proper role of the university or any outside agency to attempt to shield individuals from ideas and opinions they find unwelcome, disagreeable, or even deeply offensive.⁵ Engaging with new ideas and perspectives helps students grow intellectually and is beneficial to the educational process.

1. Statement adapted from Texas A&M University's [Syllabus Statement Regarding Academic Freedom](#)
2. 1940 Statement of Principles on Academic Freedom and Tenure
3. Board of Regents Rule 31004; HOP Policy 4.02
4. American Association of University Professors Joint Statement on Rights and Freedoms of Students
5. The Chicago Statement

Syllabus Changes

The syllabus is subject to change at the instructor's discretion. Any changes/corrections to the course materials, assignment dates, or other updates will be communicated to the students ahead of time. You are responsible for checking Canvas for corrections or updates to the syllabus.

Course Schedule

For a list of important university-wide dates, review [One Stop's academic calendar](#).

Due Date	Activities/Assignments	Points
3/4/26	HW 1	100
4/17/26	HW 2	100

Department Policies & Resources

Ombudsperson

The ombudsperson is an advocate who investigates complaints about a specific section or instructor and attempts to resolve them through mediation. Comments or complaints sent to this person will be brought to the attention of department leadership, who will follow up. If you have questions about the logistics of your class, please contact the instructor.

Contact Ilse Rosales Martinez at ilse.rosalesmartinez@utsa.edu

Tutoring Services

UTSA provides many opportunities for student success, including tutoring services for specific math courses. The list below is subject to change based on availability.

MAT 1023, MAT 1043, MAT 1053, and MAT 1073

- We offer peer-to-peer academic support to students enrolled in a variety of courses. Both drop-in tutoring and one-on-one appointments are available.
- **Location:** [Tomás Rivera Center for Academic Excellence](#) MS 2.02.18 (behind the Rowdy statue)

MAT 1053 and MAT 1073

- Synergistic Targeted Academic Review Sessions (STARS), peer-led, interactive, and group focused sessions which cover traditionally difficult topics. The schedule will be provided by instructors through Canvas.
- **Location:** Determined by STARS tutors

MAT 1093, MAT 1213/1214, and MAT 1223/1224

- The Math Gym is unique in that it's a WeBWork lab designed to offer our STEM core students support from math majors and minors through targeted SI sessions. The schedule will be provided by instructors through Canvas
- **Location:** [Math Gym FLN 03.02.08](#)

Note: Course-specific support for upper-division courses may be available for a particular semester. Please request this information from your instructor.

Essential Student Information

- **Important:** Bookmark and visit the [Common Syllabus Information webpage](#) to find important and valuable resources about counseling services, transitory/minor medical issues, supplemental instruction, tutoring services, academic success coaching, sexual harassment and sexual misconduct, campus safety and emergency preparedness, and the Roadrunner Creed.
- For technical requirements, support, and resources, visit [Academic Innovation's Student Technical Support](#) page.
- UT San Antonio provides reasonable accommodations to students via [Student Disability Services](#). For more details on eligibility, policies, and requirements, please visit [Applying for Accommodations](#) or call (210) 458-4157.
- Your well-being is important. In addition to academic growth, life as a student can include many emotional experiences and opportunities. Being mindful of your own needs and available support can provide you with the tools to successfully navigate these experiences. Student support for well-being, including [24/7 mental health services](#), can be accessed from the [Well-being at UT San Antonio](#) site for students. If needed, we can schedule a meeting, and I can connect you to resources. You are not alone; I am available to help you find resources that might best meet your needs.
- [Student Assistance Services \(SAS\)](#) is available to help you navigate academic and personal challenges. Campus Advocates in SAS are a central point of contact for students seeking clarity on university processes and policies. They also provide a direct connection to helpful resources and advocacy rooted in care. Campus Advocates offer confidential support and personalized guidance to help students succeed.
- The [Roadrunner Pantry](#) is here to help UT San Antonio students stay healthy and focused by providing free access to groceries, toiletries, and other essentials. With locations at the Main and Downtown campuses, the pantry is organized like a small store and offers items such as canned goods, snacks, and hygiene products. Students with a valid UTSA ID can visit the pantry to pick up what they need. Our goal is to ensure every Roadrunner feels supported and has the resources to succeed. If you're ever short on food or supplies, the Roadrunner Pantry is a welcoming space you can count on.
- Students at UT San Antonio are responsible for ensuring their work is consistent with UT San Antonio's standards for academic integrity. Students should review [Section 203 of the UT San Antonio Student Code of Conduct](#) for appropriate standards of academic integrity.
- UT San Antonio provides numerous services for students from counseling to tutoring to a food pantry. Visit [Student Affairs Programs and Services](#) and [Student Success](#) for more information.
- Visit the [UT San Antonio Libraries and Museums](#) site for access to journals, research tutorials, and tech gear you can borrow and to find your department's librarian.
- Enroll in the [Roadrunner Success Playbook](#), an open-enrollment, self-paced, online hub in Canvas tailored to ensure you have the resources you need to excel at UT San Antonio.
- Follow [Digital Learning Netiquette](#) standards for your online communication activities.

Student Ombudsperson

Should you have a complaint about this course that cannot be answered by the instructor, or which pertains to unjust or discriminatory treatment, please contact our third-party department representative: Ilse Rosales(ilse.rosalesmartinez@utsa.edu). Ms. Rosales can assist with an investigation and resolution of the matter.